TYLER PIKE

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PLACEMENT DIRECTORS

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EDUCATION

Ph.D.	Economics, University of Maryland at College Park, expected May 2027
M.A.	Economics, University of Maryland at College Park, 2023
B.S.	Mathematical Economics, University of Richmond, 2018

FIELDS OF SPECIALIZATION

Primary:	Macroeconomics
Secondary:	Macro-Finance, Firm Dynamics, Monetary Economics

DISSERTATION

Essays on the Macroeconomics of Financial Intermediation
Committee: Prof. Borağan Aruoba (Co-chair), Prof. John Haltiwanger (Co-chair),
Prof. Thomas Drechsel, Prof. Pablo Ottonello

JOB MARKET PAPER

"Banks as Firms: The Macroeconomics of Financial Firm Dynamics"

Why do certain banks grow large while others remain small, and how do these dynamics shape economic activity and policy? I first develop a model in which banks grow by expanding across regional loan markets and capturing market share based on differences in their ability to screen risk, attract borrowers, and source capital. Guided by this theory, I estimate U.S. bank-level fundamentals using a dynamic state-space model and embed the estimates in a quantitative multi-region New Keynesian setting. I find that banks' screening ability is the primary driver of bank dynamics, accounting for three-quarters of a bank's idiosyncratic loan growth. This is because, unlike other fundamentals, screening ability directly affects loan losses, which can trigger an accelerating balance-sheet contraction. These dynamics shape the macroeconomy through two channels. First, the distribution of screening ability determines how effectively credit is allocated to productive firms. Changes in screening ability therefore generate short-run fluctuations in aggregate labor productivity, while the level and dispersion of screening ability lower U.S. long-run labor productivity by roughly 1 and 5 percent, respectively. Second, heterogeneity in bank fundamentals generates asymmetric regional transmission of monetary policy, creating a tradeoff between aggregate stabilization and regional inequality.

PUBLICATIONS

"Bank Lending Standards and the U.S. Economy," *Journal of Economic Dynamics and Control*, 183, 105247, 2026, with Elijah Broadbent, Huberto Ennis, and Horacio Sapriza

The provision of bank credit to firms and households affects macroeconomic performance. We use survey measures of changes in bank lending standards, disaggregated by loan category, to quantify the effect of changes in banks' attitudes toward lending on aggregate output, inflation, and interest rates. Bank lending to businesses is particularly important for macroeconomic outcomes, with peak effects on output of around half a percentage point after four quarters of the initial shock. These effects depend on the stage of the business cycle and the proximity of the short-term interest rate to its effective lower bound. The effects are larger when output is growing below trend and when the interest rate is away from its lower bound. We also find that the response of the economy to lending-standards shocks is asymmetric, with tightening shocks having larger effects on output.

WORKING PAPERS

"Banks, Sentiments, and Business Cycles," 2026, under review

This paper measures the animal spirits of U.S. banks and asks whether they are an important determinant of credit conditions and source of business cycle fluctuations. I first construct a novel semi-structural measure of bank-level sentiment, revealing heterogeneous animal spirits across banks and common dynamics marked by surges in pessimism during crises and excessive optimism during periods of elevated asset prices. Using a structural BVAR that identifies bank sentiment alongside standard macroeconomic shocks, I find that bank sentiment shocks account for 24% of fluctuations in output growth and 20% in the policy rate. However, effects are time-varying and most acute in recessions when sentiment becomes a dominant source of volatility in real activity and financial conditions. These effects arise as pessimistic sentiment shocks act like a negative credit supply shock propagating primarily through the business lending channel, raising borrowing costs and tightening lending standards. Monetary policy can only partially offset these effects.

"Uncertainty, Market Concentration, and the Entrepreneurial Funding Channel"

This paper studies why uncertainty shocks have persistent effects on economic activity. I first document that shocks to uncertainty about non-financial productivity depress firm entry and raise market concentration for longer than standard transmission mechanisms can account for. I then develop a macroeconomic model with a new entrepreneurial funding channel, in which risk-averse investors become less willing to finance prospective entrepreneurs when uncertainty rises. Firm entry falls in response, creating a missing cohort of firms. Because there is no compensating rise in entry when uncertainty subsides, the missing cohort persists and the number of firms recovers only slowly. As a result, output is persistently dampened and market concentration among incumbent firms rises. Transitory uncertainty shocks can therefore generate long-lived changes in the size of the firm population and in market structure.

WORKS IN PROGRESS

"Monetary Policy, Financial Vulnerabilities, and Macro Risks," with Andrea Ajello

"Local Financial Shocks and Business Formation: Entry, Startup Scale, and Growth," with Emin Dinlersoz, Timothy Dunne, John Haltiwanger, and Veronika Penciakova

PRE-DOCTORAL RESEARCH

"Combining Forecasts: Can Machines Beat the Average?," SSRN Working Paper, 2020, with Francisco Vazquez-Grande

"Out-of-Sample Performance of Recession Probability Models," FEDS Note, 2019, with Francisco Vazquez-Grande

"Bottom-Up Leading Macroeconomic Indicators: An Application to Non-Financial Corporate Defaults Using Machine Learning," FEDS Working Paper, 2019, with Horacio Sapriza and Tom Zimmermann

CONFERENCE AND SEMINAR PRESENTATIONS

2026: SED, Econometric Society NASM, Federal Reserve Board, ASSA Annual Meeting, U.S. Census Bureau, Society of Government Economists Annual Conference
2025: DC Area Macro PhD Symposium
2024: Summer Workshop on Money, Banking, Payments, and Finance, Southern Economic Association Meeting, Midwest Macro Meeting*, LACEA-LAMES*, Econometric Society NASM*
2023: Midwest Macro Meeting, Treasury OFR PhD Symposium, DC Area Macro PhD Symposium, QCGBF Annual Conference on Monetary Policy at King's College London*
2022: SED*, Money, Macro and Finance Society Annual Conference
2019: International Finance and Banking Society Conference

* Presented by coauthor

RESEARCH AND RELEVANT WORK EXPERIENCE

Economist Intern, U.S. Census Bureau, 2023–Present
Special Sworn Status Researcher, U.S. Census Bureau, 2022–2023
Research Assistant to John Haltiwanger, University of Maryland, 2022–2023
Research Assistant to Vice Chair Clarida, Board of Governors of the Federal Reserve, 2020–2021
Research Assistant, Board of Governors of the Federal Reserve System, 2018–2021
Economic Research Intern, Federal Reserve Bank of Chicago, Summer 2017

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Instructor, Intermediate Macroeconomics (undergraduate), University of Maryland, Summer 2024
Teaching Assistant, Principles of Macroeconomics (undergraduate), University of Richmond, Fall 2017

GRANTS AND AWARDS

BSOS Dean's Research Initiative Grant, University of Maryland, 2025
Economics Department Third Year Paper Prize (second place), 2024
Melville J. Ulmer Graduate Fellowship in Economics (best second year paper), 2023
University of Maryland Graduate Fellowship, 2021
Federal Reserve Board Division Director's Award for Excellence, 2021

PROFESSIONAL ACTIVITIES

Referee for *Macroeconomic Dynamics*
Organizing committee member for the 2023 and 2024 DC Area Macro PhD Symposiums
Participant in the 2023 Princeton Initiative

COMPUTATIONAL SKILLS

R, Julia, Git, Linux, SQL, Matlab, Python, SAS, Stata

SOFTWARE PACKAGES

OOS for out-of-sample time series forecasting
sovereign for state-dependent VARs

CITIZENSHIP

United States

REFERENCES

Prof. Borağan Aruoba	University of Maryland	aruoba@umd.edu	(301) 405-3508
Prof. John Haltiwanger	University of Maryland	halt@umd.edu	(301) 405-3504
Prof. Thomas Drechsel	Johns Hopkins University	tdrechs1@jh.edu	
Prof. Pablo Ottonello	Brown University	pablo_ottonello@brown.edu	